

7.2 Patterns of power change over time and can be uni-, bi- or multi-polar.	a. The maintenance of power during the imperial era by direct militarised colonial control (British Empire, multipolar world 1919–1939).
	b. Multi-faceted, indirect control (political, economic, military, cultural) including neo-colonial mechanisms has become more important (Cold War era; emergence of China as a potential rival to the USA's hegemony). (2)
	c. Different patterns of power bring varying degrees of geopolitical stability and risk.